Safety Experiences

Ventral vagal safety is a state of *connection* to environment, others, and self. Bodily processes are optimized for homeostatic health, growth, and restoration. Safety enables executive functioning and repurposes defensive activation for play, stillness, intimacy, and motivation. Self-regulation out of stuck defense is possible when in safety.

Cognitions

optimistic
understanding
interested
focused
logical
abstract
consistent
balanced
present
attentive
open
learn
reflective
imaginative
analytical
innovative
curious
insightful
mindful
accepting
adaptable
strategic
creative
decisive
spontaneous
problem-solving

Emotions

motivated
appreciative
grateful
connected
caring
joy
playful
happy
confident
loving
calm
excited
peaceful
fulfilled
compassionate
hopeful
optimistic
content
nurturing
inspired
proud
encouraged
cheerful
elated
valued

Sensations

warm
expanse
smooth
tender
open
spacious
understood
aware
whole
light
touched
shimmering
soft
flowing
grounded
balanced
gentle
harmonious
radiant
centered
energized
weightless
relaxed
serene
vibrant
glowing

Impulses

touch
socialize
connect
co-regulate
eye contact
share
empathize
smile
listen
mindful
reach
hold
explore
engage
laugh
hug
comfort
collaborate
assist
include
synchronize
appreciate
communicate
play
trust
invite
join

More resources
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